"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 45

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

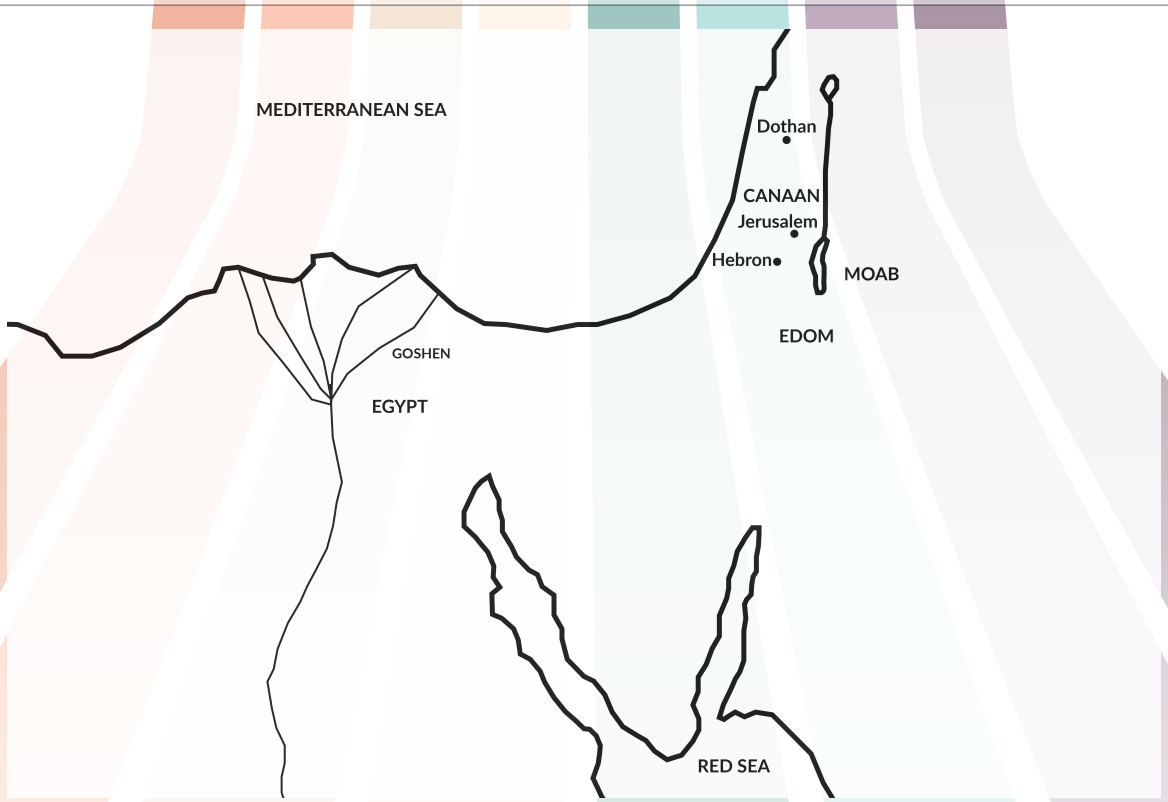
- Joseph was 17 when he went to Egypt as a slave (approximately 1728 B.C.).
- Joseph was 30 years old when he became a ruler of Egypt (approx.. 1715 B.C.).
- Joseph revealed his identity to his brothers in the 2nd year of the 7-year famine (approx. 1706 B.C.).

Characters:

- Joseph – Jacob's son with Rachel. In this chapter, he was the second most powerful man in Egypt.
- Joseph's 11 Brothers – In Genesis 42, 10 of the brothers travelled to Egypt to buy food during a famine. They returned to Egypt in chapter 43-44 with their youngest brother, Benjamin.
- Pharaoh – The king of Egypt.
- Jacob – The grandson of Abraham and the father of Joseph and his 11 brothers.

Where:

- Joseph's brothers travelled from Canaan to Egypt to buy food during a famine.
- Joseph invited his family to leave Canaan and move to Goshen.



Outline:

- JOSEPH REVEALS HIS IDENTITY TO HIS BROTHERS (45:1-8):
  + After hearing Judah's offer to redeem his brother Benjamin from slavery (44:33), Joseph became emotional.
  + He told all the Egyptians in the room to leave and then revealed his identity to his brothers.
  + He asked them if his father was still alive, but they were too stunned to answer.
  + Joseph told his brothers not to be distressed because he believed it was God who sent him to Egypt to save innumerable people from the famine.
- JOSEPH INVITES HIS FAMILY TO LIVE IN EGYPT (45:9-15):
  + There were still 5 years remaining in the 7-year famine (45:6) so Joseph told his brothers to bring their father and their families to live in Egypt.
  + He invited them to live in the land of Goshen.
  + Joseph wept and talked with his brothers.
- PHARAOH'S HOSPITALITY (45:16-20):
  + When Pharaoh's house heard Joseph's brothers had arrived, it pleased Pharaoh and all his servants.
  + Pharaoh gave the 11 brothers wagons to use in transporting their wives and children to Egypt.
  + He told them not to worry about their possessions because he would give them the best of Egypt.
- JACOB'S SONS RETURN TO CANAAN WITH GIFTS AND GOOD NEWS (45:21-28):
  + Joseph gave each of his brothers a new pair of clothes before they left, but he gave Benjamin 300 shekels of silver and 5 changes of clothes.
  + He sent 20 donkeys laden with gifts to his father.
  + When Jacob's sons arrived back in Canaan, they told their father Joseph was still alive and had become a ruler in Egypt.
  + Initially Jacob didn't believe them.
  + But after talking to them further and seeing the wagons Pharaoh sent, the Bible says, "the spirit of their father Jacob revived."
  + Jacob agreed to move to Egypt because he wanted to see Joseph before he died.

Application:

- God is always at work, even when it looks like He is absent.
- Looking back at his life, Joseph understood how God used his brother's evil actions to bring about something good.
- We need to understand that just because something bad happens to us doesn't mean God is no longer directing our lives or that He's abandoned us.
- Our bad circumstances may only be the introduction to a story in which God works through us in incredible ways.
- It's also very encouraging and relieving to know God can take the sins we've committed against people in the past and turn them for good.